

# Ken Merrell Complete Platform Guide

Welcome to your complete platform guide. This document explains every feature on the live website, where your visitors see it, and exactly how you can edit and manage it from your custom Content Management System (CRM).

## Accessing the CRM

To make any changes to your website, you must log in to your CRM dashboard:

1. Go to your live website.
2. Add /admin to the end of the URL (e.g., [www.kenmerrell.com/admin](http://www.kenmerrell.com/admin)).
3. Log in with your secure credentials.

Once logged in, any changes you save will instantly update the live website. (If you don't see changes immediately on the live site, perform a Hard Refresh: Ctrl+F5 on Windows, or Cmd+Shift+R on Mac).

## Feature 1: The Homepage Banner & Praise Quotes

Where it is on the website:

Right at the very top of the homepage, below the main title. This is a dynamic carousel of quotes that swipe back and forth to immediately capture the visitor's attention.

How to edit and change it in the CRM:

- In the CRM, click on the 'About' tab on the left sidebar.
- Scroll down to the 'Homepage quotes' section.
- Here you can edit the text, the subtext, and the author of each quote.
- You can add new quotes by clicking 'Add a quote', or remove them. (3 to 4 quotes work best).
- Click 'Save Changes' at the top to publish.

## Feature 2: The Author Biography & Photo

Where it is on the website:

When visitors click 'About' in the navigation menu, they are taken to the About section which features your professional headshot, a highlighted 'pull quote', and your full biography.

How to edit and change it in the CRM:

- In the CRM, click on the 'About' tab.
- Under 'Author photo', you can upload a new portrait image.
- Under 'About Ken', you can edit the 'Pull Quote' (the large highlight text) and the full 'Bio' text.
- Note: Leave a blank line in the text box to start a new paragraph.

## Feature 3: The Book Catalog

Where it is on the website:

The main focus of the website. Books are categorized into two visually distinct shelves: 'Available Now' and 'Coming Soon'. Visitors can click on any book to see more details.

How to edit and change it in the CRM:

- In the CRM, click on the 'Books' tab.
- You will see a list of all your books. Click on a book to edit it, or click 'Add a Book'.
- To move a book from the 'Coming Soon' shelf to the 'Available Now' shelf on the live site, simply change the 'Status' dropdown from 'Coming Soon' to 'Available'.

## Feature 4: The Individual Book Details & Purchase Links

Where it is on the website:

When a visitor clicks on a specific book cover, it opens that book's dedicated page showing the cover, description, page count, ISBN, and large 'Buy on Amazon' / 'Buy on Audible' buttons.

How to edit and change it in the CRM:

- In the CRM, click on the 'Books' tab, then click on the book you want to edit.
- You can upload a new cover image.
- You can update the Title, Tagline, Description, Pages, and ISBN.
- To make the 'Buy' buttons appear on the live site, paste your Amazon or Audible link into the 'Purchase Links' section. (If you leave a link blank, that specific button will automatically hide itself on the live site).

## Feature 5: The Interactive 3D Flipbook Reader

Where it is on the website:

On an individual book page, visitors will see a 'Read Sample' section. Clicking this opens a gorgeous, interactive 3D flipbook that feels like reading a physical book, allowing them to flip through a sample chapter.

How to edit and change it in the CRM:

- In the CRM, click on the 'Books' tab, then click on a book.
- Scroll down to the 'Sample chapter' section.
- You can upload a PDF (.pdf), Word document (.docx), or Text file (.txt) preferable to do this most of the time. The system will automatically extract the text.
- The flipbook engine automatically formats the text, seamlessly packing it to exactly 16 lines per page with no gaps, to mimic a real physical book.
- To create a scene break in the chapter, type '\*\*\*' on its own line.

## Feature 6: The Cinematic Video Trailers

Where it is on the website:

Videos appear in two places. First, the top video is featured prominently on the homepage, with smaller videos beside it. Second, if a video title matches a book title, the video will automatically embed itself onto that specific book's page.

How to edit and change it in the CRM:

- In the CRM, click on the 'Videos' tab.
- Paste any YouTube URL into the box. The CRM will automatically fetch the video and its title.
- You can use the UP and DOWN arrows next to any video to change their order.
- The video at the very top of the list is always the one featured largest on the homepage.

## Feature 7: Advance Reader Signups & Notifications

Where it is on the website:

When a visitor views a book on the 'Coming Soon' shelf, instead of purchase buttons, they see a form to sign up as an 'Advance Reader' for that specific book.

How to edit and change it in the CRM:

- In the CRM, click on the 'Readers' tab.
- Here you will see a list of every visitor who has signed up to be an advance reader.
- You can filter the list to see who requested eBook formats vs. Paperback formats.
- Click the 'Export CSV' button to download this list for your email newsletter software.
- To control where you receive email alerts when someone signs up, go to the 'About' tab, and update the 'Notification Email' at the bottom of the page.